Game Modification Task Sheet: Kaudi

Institution: Centurion University of Technology and Management (CUTM)
Project: Native & Indigenous Sports of India (Title 18)
Review Date: September 2026
Evaluator: Lead Game Systems Analyst & Heritage Design Team

Game Reviewed:

Kaudi (Traditional Indian Cowrie Shell Scoring & Race Game)

Game Platform:

Cross-Platform WebGL / HTML5 Canvas / Progressive Web App (PWA) / Android / iOS

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1. Provide a detailed overview of the object of the game.

The fundamental object of **Kaudi** is to be the first player to accumulate a pre-agreed target score (standard: 100 points; short match: 50 points) by casting a clutch of natural cowrie shells (*Cypraea moneta*) into a playing arena. Points are awarded based on how many shells land with their aperture (mouth) facing upwards. In the traditional format, players compete in turn-based rounds. In the modernized digital adaptation, players can also engage in an optional "Press-Your-Luck" mechanism where they can repeatedly toss shells during a single turn to compound their round score, provided they don't roll a "bust" combination, which wipes out all unbanked points from that turn. The game concludes immediately when a player safely banks enough points to meet or surpass the target threshold.

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2. List 3 or more things you like about the game. Why?

1. **Authentic Tactile Physics & Acoustic Satisfaction**:
Why: Unlike standard cubical six-sided dice, cowrie shells possess natural organic asymmetry, weight differences, and curved contours. Digitalizing their rotational toss, multi-bounce scatter, and distinct hollow ceramic clatter creates an unusually satisfying, tactile sensory loop that feels hand-crafted rather than synthetic.

2. **The High-Tension "Press-Your-Luck" Risk-Reward Dynamic**:
Why: Pure dice rolling can sometimes become passive or repetitive. Introducing the Press-Your-Luck mechanic transforms every subsequent toss into an electrifying psychological dilemma: *Do I bank my 14 points now and stay safe, or do I roll once more to chase victory and risk losing it all?* This creates high spectator excitement and player agency.

3. **High Reusability as a Foundational Engine Service**:
Why: Kaudi is not just an isolated mini-game; its core rules engine (`CowrieDice`) serves as the modular random number generator and animation service for an entire family of ancient Indian race games (including *Ashtapada*, *Chauka Bara*, *Pachisi*, and *Pasha Palli*). Building this game cleanly delivers enormous architectural efficiency across the entire 18-title collection.

4. **Instant Cultural Accessibility Across Generations**:
Why: The rules require less than thirty seconds to learn: simply count the open shell mouths. This low cognitive barrier allows young children, casual mobile players, and senior family members to compete on completely equal footing without needing prior gaming literacy.

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3. List 3 or more things you do not like about the game. Why?

1. **High Variance & Risk of Runaway Leaders (Pure Luck Factor)**:
Why: Because cowrie throws are fundamentally governed by binomial probability distributions, an early lucky streak (e.g., rolling two *Chamma* or *Ashtam* throws in succession) can grant one player an insurmountable lead before their opponent has taken multiple turns, leading to feeling helpless.

2. **Potential Player Fatigue During Low-Scoring Grinds**:
Why: With 6 shells, the single most common statistical outcome is 3 or 4 mouths up, yielding modest points (3 or 4 points per turn). If players play very conservatively in target-100 matches, a game can occasionally drag on for 20+ turns without dramatic momentum shifts.

3. **Lack of Defensive or Interactive Counter-Play in the Raw Base Rules**:
Why: In the pure historical scoring contest, players throw in isolation without directly interacting with or hindering their opponent's score. It is purely a parallel race rather than an interactive contest with blocks or captures.

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4. List 3 or more reasons why you think the game you are reviewing is successful.

1. **Deep Cultural Resonance & Heritage Authenticity**:
Kaudi is deeply rooted in Indian folklore, festivals (such as Diwali and Lakshmi Puja where cowries represent prosperity), and regional literature. By framing the game with authentic Centurion University Design Bible aesthetics (carved teakwood, woven coir, temple sandstone, and Mukta typography), the game feels culturally legitimate rather than like a cheap digital skin.

2. **Snappy, Micro-Session Pacing (5–10 Minutes)**:
Matches are fast, decisive, and exciting. Players can complete a full 100-point match during a short commute, coffee break, or between classes. The rapid restart loop encourages "just one more rematch" behavior.

3. **Flawless Multi-Platform Performance & Zero Barrier to Entry**:
Because the game is engineered without bloated 3D engines or external heavy dependencies, it loads instantaneously (<2 seconds) in any mobile or desktop web browser, consumes minimal battery, and supports complete offline play via Progressive Web App (PWA) caching.

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5. Recommended Digital Modifications & Feature Enhancements

To address the limitations noted above, the following modifications have been implemented and recommended for ongoing development:

Modification	Problem Solved	Implementation Detail
"Catch-Up / Grace Throw" Mechanic	Eliminates runaway leader fatigue	If a trailing player is behind by 30+ points, their next non-scoring roll is granted a single "Grace Re-roll" rather than an immediate bust.
Consecutive Bonus Cap	Prevents infinite turn dominance	Limit consecutive bonus throws on *Chamma* (all up) and *Ashtam* (all down) to a maximum of 3 consecutive throws per turn.
Adjustable Target Thresholds (50 / 100 / 150)	Accommodates different player time constraints	Provides a "Blitz Match" (50 pts / 3 mins), "Standard Match" (100 pts / 7 mins), and "Grand Championship" (150 pts / 12 mins).

Modification	Problem Solved	Implementation Detail
Tactical Blessing Tokens (Future DLC / Variant)	Introduces direct player agency	Players receive one single-use "Lakshmi Token" per match that allows them to re-roll a single unwanted shell of their choice.